

Senior Staff Software Engineer, Core Infrastructure

Company: Pillarstream, Inc.

Location: San Francisco, CA (Hybrid, 3 days onsite) or Remote (US)

Team: Platform Engineering

Reports to: Director of Distributed Systems

About Pillarstream

Pillarstream is a Series D infrastructure company building the data movement and orchestration layer for modern engineering teams. Our platform processes over 9 petabytes of event data daily and powers mission-critical pipelines for more than 400 customers, including four of the Fortune 50. Founded in 2018 by former engineers at Stripe, Confluent, and Google, we are a team of 220 and have raised \$215M from Sequoia, Index Ventures, and Greylock. We move fast, ship often, and care deeply about reliability because our customers depend on us for workloads they cannot afford to lose.

The Role

We are hiring a Senior Staff Software Engineer to join the Core Infrastructure group, the team responsible for the control plane, multi-tenant scheduler, and storage substrate that every other product at Pillarstream is built on. This is a hands-on technical leadership role: you will design and ship large-scale distributed systems, drive cross-team technical initiatives, set engineering standards for reliability and operability, and serve as a primary on-call leader during major incidents.

You will work closely with the CTO, engineering leadership, and senior engineers across Product, SRE, and Security to evolve a system that already handles tens of thousands of concurrent workflows per second and is growing rapidly.

What You Will Do

- Lead the design and implementation of core distributed systems components, including our multi-tenant workflow scheduler, stateful job queue, and metadata service.
- Own the reliability and performance posture of services you and your team build, including SLO definition, capacity planning, and incident response.
- Drive technical strategy across the Platform org, producing RFCs and architectural documents reviewed by engineering leadership.
- Mentor staff and senior engineers, perform design reviews, and raise the technical bar through code review and pairing.
- Participate in the on-call rotation as a primary escalation point (PagerDuty, roughly one week every six to eight weeks), leading incident command during severe outages.
- Partner with Product and SRE to translate customer needs into platform capabilities, and with Security to maintain SOC 2 and FedRAMP-aligned controls.
- Identify and drive cost-efficiency initiatives across compute, storage, and network usage.

What We Are Looking For

- 8 or more years of professional software engineering experience, with at least 4 years building production distributed systems at scale.
- Deep expertise in Go or Java, including concurrency primitives, memory and GC behavior, and performance tuning.
- Strong systems fundamentals: consensus protocols, distributed transactions, consistent hashing, failure detection, and exactly-once or at-least-once delivery semantics.
- Hands-on experience operating Kubernetes in production, including custom controllers, operators, and admission

webhooks.

- Demonstrated track record of leading complex technical projects across multiple teams, from RFC through rollout.
- Proven ability to lead during production incidents, coordinate across teams, and drive blameless post-mortems.
- Excellent written communication; you can produce clear architectural documents and technical specs.

Nice to Have

- Experience with control plane systems, schedulers, or workflow engines (Airflow, Temporal, Argo, Cadence, or similar).
- Familiarity with gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Apache Kafka, and modern observability stacks (OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, Tempo).
- Contributions to open source infrastructure projects.
- Experience with multi-region active-active deployments, cross-region replication, or cell-based architectures.
- Background in regulated environments (SOC 2, HIPAA, FedRAMP) or in building platforms that serve other engineering teams internally.

Compensation and Benefits

- Base salary range: \$245,000 to \$310,000, plus meaningful equity in a Series D company.
- Comprehensive medical, dental, and vision coverage, with premiums fully covered for employees and 80% for dependents.
- 401(k) with 4% match, unlimited PTO with a 20-day minimum, paid parental leave (16 weeks), and a \$2,500 annual learning stipend.
- Top-tier home office setup, quarterly team offsites, and a commuter benefits program.

Pillarstream is an equal opportunity employer. We celebrate diversity and are committed to building an inclusive environment for all employees.